INTERCESSORY PRAYER

Leader's Manual



WELCOME

to Garden City Church's Intercessory Prayer Ministry. This ministry is dedicated to the purpose of following Jesus' example and call to intercession. The Bible states that "Therefore [Jesus] is able to save completely those who come to God through Him, because He always lives to intercede for them" (Hebrews 7:25). To be a disciple of Jesus is to be an imitator of Jesus, and to imitate Jesus is to engage in intercession.

We are also directly mandated "...that supplications, prayers, intercessions, and thanksgivings be made for all people, for kings and all who are in high positions, that we may lead a peaceful and quiet life, godly and dignified in every way" (1 Timothy 2:1-2). As followers of Jesus, intercession is a key part of *living the life* - a life transformed by Jesus joyfully carries out His command to not only pray, but also pray for others. And as we pray for the needs of our community, the lost, and opportunities to share God's love, we also support the mission to *tell the story* of Jesus. This manual will guide you through some of Garden City's guidelines for group intercession. As you serve, stay encouraged that "the prayer of a righteous person is powerful and effective" (James 5:15).

REQUIREMENTS

WHY?

- We want to minister from a place of testimony, love, faith and power.
- We want to pray effective fervent prayers - that availeth much (or yield results).
- We have been given this ministry.

SAVED

While God can use unsaved people, ministry is an off-shoot of salvation.

Ephesians 2:10
For we are God's handiwork, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance for us to do.

PURSUING SANCTIFICATION/HOLINESS

Hebrews 12:14
Make every effort to live in peace with everyone and to be holy; without holiness no one will see the Lord.

1 Peter 1:22
Now that you have purified yourselves by obeying the truth so that you have sincere love for each other, love one another deeply, from the heart.

2 Peter 1:5-9
For this very reason, make every effort to add to your faith goodness; and to goodness, knowledge; and to knowledge, self-control; and to self-control, perseverance; and to perseverance, godliness; and to godliness, mutual affection; and to mutual affection, love. For if you possess these qualities in increasing measure, they will keep you from being ineffective and unproductive in your knowledge of our Lord Jesus Christ. But whoever does not have them is nearsighted and blind, forgetting that they have been cleansed from their past sins.

DELIVERED (EVIDENCE OF SIN BREAKING OFF)

Luke 8:38-39
The man from whom the demons had gone out begged that he might be with him, but Jesus sent him away, saying, "Return to your home, and declare how much God has done for you." So he went away, proclaiming throughout the city how much Jesus had done for him.

FILLED WITH THE HOLY SPIRIT

Mark 16:15-19

He said to them, “Go into all the world and preach the gospel to all creation. Whoever believes and is baptized will be saved, but whoever does not believe will be condemned. And these signs will accompany those who believe: In my name they will drive out demons; they will speak in new tongues; they will pick up snakes with their hands; and when they drink deadly poison, it will not hurt them at all; they will place their hands on sick people, and they will get well.”

DISQUALIFIERS

1. Actively entangled in sin.
2. Currently NOT believing that God can heal, deliver, or intervene supernaturally.
3. Not willing to commit to prayer, fasting and Bible reading.

PRAYER MODEL OUTLINES

Introductory Posture: A Heart Ready to Receive

“When we come into this house, we need to love the possibility that God is larger than our theology or understanding more than we are involved with our theology and understanding. So, we come with a posture to receive.”

WE PRAY FOR DIRECTION AND CLARITY

PRAY WITH PURPOSE, NOT AIMLESSLY

1 Corinthians 9:26 (NIV)

Therefore I do not run like someone running aimlessly; I do not fight like a boxer beating the air.

PRAY TO ENGAGE IN SPIRITUAL BATTLE

2 Corinthians 10:4-6 (NIV)

“The weapons we fight with are not the weapons of the world. On the contrary, they have divine power to demolish strongholds. We demolish arguments and every pretension that sets itself up against the knowledge of God, and we take captive every thought to make it obedient to Christ. And we will be ready to punish every act of disobedience, once your obedience is complete.”

THE 5 SPHERES OF JESUS' MINISTRY (OUR MODEL IN PRAYER)

1. PRAYER

Hebrews 5:7 (NASB)
In the days of His flesh, He offered up both prayers and supplications with loud crying and tears to the One able to save Him from death, and He was heard because of His piety.

2. DELIVERANCE

Mark 16:17 (NASB)
And these signs will accompany those who believe: In my name they will drive out demons; they will speak in new tongues."

3. HEALING

Acts 10:38 (NASB)
"You know of Jesus of Nazareth, how God anointed Him with the Holy Spirit and with power, and how He went about doing good and healing all who were oppressed by the devil, for God was with Him."

4. PROCLAIMING THE KINGDOM

Luke 4:43 (NIV)
"But he said, 'I must proclaim the good news of the kingdom of God to the other towns also, because that is why I was sent.'"

5. TEACHING

Luke 21:37 (NIV)
"Each day Jesus was teaching at the temple, and each evening he went out to spend the night on the hill called the Mount of Olives."

FOUNDATION FOR EFFECTIVE PRAYER

1. THE HOLY SPIRIT HELPS US PRAY

Romans 8:26 (NIV)
"In the same way, the Spirit helps us in our weakness. We do not know what we ought to pray for, but the Spirit himself intercedes for us through wordless groans."

Ephesians 6:18 (NIV)
"And pray in the Spirit on all occasions with all kinds of prayers and requests. With this in mind, be alert and always keep on praying for all the Lord's people."

2. PRAYING IN THE SPIRIT

Jude 1:20 (NIV)
"But you, dear friends, by building yourselves up in your most holy faith and praying in the Holy Spirit…"

1 Corinthians 14:4 (NIV)
"Anyone who speaks in a tongue edifies themselves, but the one who prophesies edifies the church."

1 Corinthians 14:18 (NIV)
"I thank God that I speak in tongues more than all of you."

NOTE:
Understand the difference between public tongues (for the church with interpretation) and private prayer in the Spirit (for personal edification).

3. MINIMUM TIME IN PRAYER MODELED BY JESUS

Matthew 26:40 (NIV)
"Then he returned to his disciples and found them sleeping. 'Couldn't you men keep watch with me for one hour?' he asked Peter."

4. PRAYING GOD'S WORD

Psalm 119:49 (NIV)
"Remember your word to your servant, for you have given me hope."

Isaiah 62:6 (NASB)
"On your walls, Jerusalem, I have appointed watchmen; All day and all night they will never keep silent. You who profess the LORD, take no rest for yourselves."

5. WAITING IN SILENCE BEFORE GOD

Lamentations 3:24-28
"'The Lord is my portion,' says my soul, 'Therefore I have hope in Him.' The Lord is good to those who wait for Him, to the person who seeks Him. It is good that he waits silently for the salvation of the Lord. It is good for a man that he should bear the yoke in his youth. Let him sit alone and be silent since He has laid it on him."

5 SPHERES OF DAILY PRAYER PRACTICE

Spend 1 minute each on the following:

1. Pray for yourself
2. Pray for immediate family
3. Pray for church family
4. Pray for community leaders
5. Pray for community (unsaved, hurting, broken)

You may also add 1 minute of Scripture per sphere.

THREE MODES OF PRAYING SCRIPTURE

1. Tongues (75%) – Personal edification and Spirit-led intercession
2. Pray the Word – Declare and claim God's promises
3. Pray by Waiting in Silence – Restful, listening, surrendered posture

A FOURFOLD PATTERN

Jude 1:20-21 (NASB)

"But you, beloved, building yourselves up on your most holy faith, praying in the Holy Spirit, keep yourselves in the love of God, waiting anxiously for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ to eternal life."

1. **Build yourself up in your most holy faith** – Remain in the teachings of Christ
2. **Pray in the Holy Spirit** – Let the Spirit shape your prayers
3. **Keep yourself in the love of God** – Stay aligned with His heart
4. **Wait for His appearing** – Live with expectancy



Garden City Church
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